

Flow of Communication & Barriers to Communication

BY: ADNAN AHMED

Flow of Communication

Flow of communication refers to the direction in which information moves within an organization or between individuals.

- ❖ Downward Communication
- ❖ Upward Communication
- ❖ Horizontal (Lateral) Communication
- ❖ Diagonal Communication
- ❖ External Communication

Flow of Communication

Downward Communication

Communication that flows from higher authority to lower levels.

Examples:

- ❖ Manager assigning tasks to developers
- ❖ Project lead issuing guidelines for model deployment
- ❖ University administration issuing policies

Purpose:

- ✓ Instructions, Policies, Feedback, etc.

Flow of Communication

Upward Communication

Communication that flows from subordinates to superiors.

Examples:

- ❖ Progress reports submitted by team members
- ❖ Bug reports or feasibility concerns
- ❖ Feedback to management

Purpose:

- ✓ Reporting, Suggestions, Problem escalation, etc.

Flow of Communication

Horizontal (Lateral) Communication

Communication between people at the same organizational level.

Examples:

- ❖ AI/MMG engineers collaborating
- ❖ Data scientists sharing results
- ❖ Team coordination meetings

Purpose:

- ✓ Coordination, Problem-solving, Teamwork, etc.

Flow of Communication

Diagonal Communication

Communication across different departments and levels.

Examples:

- ❖ AI/MMG developer communicating directly with the finance officer
- ❖ Technical staff consulting the HR or legal team

Purpose:

- ✓ Speed, Cross-functional collaboration, etc.

Flow of Communication

External Communication

Communication between an organization and outside stakeholders.

Examples:

- ❖ Proposal sent to the funding agency
- ❖ Client documentation
- ❖ Technical reports for regulators

Barriers to Communication

Communication barriers are obstacles that distort, delay, or block effective understanding.

- ❖ Language Barriers
- ❖ Technical Barriers
- ❖ Psychological Barriers
- ❖ Cultural Barriers
- ❖ Organizational Barriers
- ❖ Physical Barriers
- ❖ Semantic Barriers
- ❖ Information Overload

Barriers to Communication

Language Barriers

- ❖ Use of complex, unclear, or inappropriate language.

Example:

- ❖ Excessive technical jargon in a report for management
- ❖ Use plain English, adjust language to the audience, etc.

Barriers to Communication

Technical Barriers

- ❖ Problems related to the medium or technology.

Example:

- ❖ Poor internet during online meetings
- ❖ Software incompatibility

Barriers to Communication

Psychological Barriers

- ❖ Emotional or mental states affecting communication.

Example:

- ❖ Fear of speaking to seniors
- ❖ Stress or anxiety

Barriers to Communication

Cultural Barriers

- ❖ Differences in values, norms, or communication styles.

Example:

- ❖ Direct vs indirect communication styles
- ❖ Gender norms affecting participation

Barriers to Communication

Organizational Barriers

- ❖ Issues caused by the organizational structure or hierarchy.

Example:

- ❖ Too many approval levels
- ❖ Poor reporting channels

Barriers to Communication

Physical Barriers

- ❖ Environmental obstacles.

Example:

- ❖ Noise in workplace
- ❖ Poor classroom acoustics

Barriers to Communication

Semantic Barriers

- ❖ Different meanings assigned to the same words.

Example:

- ❖ Misinterpretation of terms like “deployment” or “accuracy”

Barriers to Communication

Information Overload

Too much information delivered at once.

Example:

- ❖ Long emails without structure
- ❖ Overly detailed reports

References

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THANKS.

BY: ADNAN AHMED

